

High-Protein Andhra Pappu Variations

These traditional Andhra-style pappu recipes have been adapted to work as balanced, filling, lower-carb meals where the lentils serve as the primary carbohydrate source. The recipes focus on increasing protein, fiber, satiety, and micronutrient density while preserving authentic flavor.

1. Tomato Pappu – High Protein Balanced Version

Base Ingredients

- 1/4 cup toor dal + 1/4 cup moong dal (or preferred combination)
- 4–5 chopped tomatoes
- 2 slit green chillies
- Curry leaves
- 1/4 tsp turmeric
- Salt to taste
- Water as needed

Method

1. Wash and soak the lentils for at least 1 hour. Hot water soaking may be used.
2. Drain and rinse once more.
3. Add lentils to the pressure cooker with enough water to cover them.
4. Place a trivet inside the cooker and keep another vessel containing tomatoes, green chillies, curry leaves, turmeric, salt, and 1/2 cup water.
5. Pressure cook on medium-high heat for 5–6 whistles.
6. Allow pressure to settle naturally.
7. Mash the cooked lentils and combine with the tomato mixture.
8. Simmer for a few minutes and prepare the tadka.

Tadka

Use 2 tsp ghee + 1 tsp sesame oil (or 1 tbsp avocado oil).

Add:

- Mustard seeds
- Jeera
- Small pinch methi seeds
- Hing
- Chilli flakes or crushed red chillies

Optional: crushed garlic and fresh coriander.

Protein & Nutrition Enhancements (Choose 1–2)

- 1 tbsp hemp hearts + 1 tsp flax meal after simmering
- 100g tofu cubes added during simmering
- Serve with 1/2 to 3/4 cup Greek yogurt
- Sprinkle roasted peanut-sesame-flax podi

Vegetable Boosters

Add one of the following while pressure cooking:

- Spinach
- Ridge gourd
- Bottle gourd
- Mushrooms
- Zucchini
- Cabbage
- Moringa leaves

2. Menthikura Pappu – Protein Enhanced Version

Base Ingredients

- 1/4 cup toor dal + 1/4 cup moong dal
- Fresh methi leaves, cleaned and chopped
- 2–3 chopped tomatoes
- 2–3 slit green chillies
- 2 tbsp peanuts + 1 tbsp pumpkin seeds + 1 tbsp hemp hearts
- Small lemon-sized tamarind extract
- Salt and turmeric to taste

Method

1. Soak lentils for at least 1 hour and cook separately until soft.
2. Soak peanuts in hot water for 1 hour or overnight.
3. In the pressure cooker add methi leaves, tomatoes, soaked peanuts, green chillies, tamarind extract, salt, and turmeric.
4. Pressure cook on high for 3–4 whistles.
5. Release pressure immediately.
6. Add the cooked dal and adjust consistency with hot water as needed.
7. Simmer gently and finish with tadka.

Tadka

Use about 1 tbsp oil or a mix of ghee and sesame oil.

Add:

- Mustard seeds
- Jeera
- Hing
- Crushed dry red chillies

Protein Enhancement Options

- 1/2 cup shelled edamame
- Lightly steamed sprouted moong
- 75–100g paneer cubes
- Optional whey isolate blended into warm yogurt after switching off heat

Additional Tips

- To reduce bitterness: use 70% methi + 30% spinach or amaranth leaves.
- For better satiety: add 1 tsp psyllium or a small chia slurry after cooking.
- Best served with sautéed vegetables, yogurt, and salad rather than large rice portions.

Balanced Meal Principle: Keep lentils moderate, increase vegetables, include protein additions, and use controlled healthy fats for better fullness, digestion, and glucose response.